Instead of merely having the object in a superposition, the bigger system of object and environment would itself be in a superposition. And, without an interpretation to explain what that superposition means, the measurement problem would remain: Why don't we ever see dead-and-alive cats in the real world? Why does the Schrödinger equation work so well for small objects yet appears to fail so miserably for the objects of everyday life?

Zeh, unsurprisingly, agreed that "environment-induced decoherence by itself does not solve the measurement problem"—he contended that Everett's many-worlds interpretation was needed to complete the picture. And Zurek, despite his *Physics Today* article, did agree that decoherence was not the whole solution. He had been much clearer about this in his very first paper on decoherence, where he said explicitly that decoherence could not address the question of "what causes the collapse of the system-apparatus-environment combined wave function?" But Zurek's views on many-worlds weren't like Zeh's. Instead, they were somewhat reminiscent of those of his mentor, Wheeler—Zurek tried to find a diplomatic way to reconcile Everett's many worlds with Bohr's Copenhagen interpretation, just as Wheeler had attempted on his ill-fated trip to Copenhagen in 1956.

Unfortunately, many physicists took Zurek's diplomatic approach as a sign that decoherence somehow vindicated the Copenhagen interpretation. To them, decoherence was, like the Copenhagen interpretation itself, a magic phrase that could be invoked to dispel the specter of the measurement problem and the rest of the halo of weirdness surrounding quantum theory. Experiments probing decoherence in the late 1990s only added fuel to the fire: as the quantitative predictions of decoherence were confirmed, some physicists concluded that the measurement problem had finally been laid to rest. Among many others, Philip Anderson—the same physicist who had accepted Bell's theorem for publication, apparently on the erroneous understanding that Bell had ruled out Bohm's pilot-wave theory—fell victim to this error. In 2001, he stated that "'decoherence'… describes the process that used to be called 'collapse of the wave function.' The concept is now experimentally verified by beautiful atomic beam techniques quantifying the whole process." Anderson's misunderstanding about the nature of decoherence, like his misunderstanding of Bell's result, was definitely not due to any serious deficiency as a physicist on his part—Anderson won the Nobel Prize in 1977 for his seminal contributions to